

Final Project: Climate Plan Audit

CEVE 421/521

Draft Material — This content is under development and subject to change.

1 Overview

Working in small teams, you will act as expert consultants to audit a real-world climate planning document. Your chosen document must be **decision-relevant**—it should contain identifiable decisions (Levers) and measurable outcomes (Metrics).

The project is built through two Audit Memos to ensure steady progress, culminating in an Executive Briefing presentation and a final Written Report.

2 Timeline

Deadline	Deliverable	Description
Week 3 (Friday)	Topic Proposal	Submit document choice and confirm it contains identifiable Levers (L) and Metrics (M).
Week 8 (Monday)	Teams & Plans Assigned	Instructor assigns teams and plans in class.
Week 10 (Friday)	Memo 1 (XLRM Framework)	Map the plan's Uncertainties (X), Levers (L), System Models (R), and Metrics (M). What is the complete decision framework?
Week 12 (Friday)	Memo 2 (Evidence & Robustness)	Critique the plan's Valuation approach and Robustness. How strong is the evidence? How does the plan handle deep uncertainty?
Week 13 (Friday)	Slides Due	All teams must submit their presentation slides.
Week 14	Executive Briefing	A 20-minute team presentation with 5 minutes of Q&A.
Finals	Written Report	A synthesis of your memos with a final recommendation.

3 Team Formation

- Students submit individual topic proposals in Week 3
- In Week 8, the instructor assigns teams of 2-3 students based on topic overlap and interest
- Each team is assigned a climate plan to audit

4 Choosing a Plan

Your document must be:

1. **Publicly Available:** The plan should be accessible online.

2. **Decision-Relevant:** It should contain identifiable Levers (decisions) and Metrics (outcomes).
3. **Climate-Related:** The plan should address climate hazards or climate change adaptation/mitigation.

Good examples include:

- City or regional climate action plans
- Flood risk management strategies
- Coastal resilience plans
- Infrastructure adaptation assessments

5 Grading

Deliverable	Weight
Topic Proposal	5%
Memo 1	15%
Memo 2	15%
Executive Briefing	30%
Written Report	35%

Memos are progress checks that build toward the final deliverables. The executive briefing and written report together make up the bulk of the grade.

Bibliography